

are included within a CD to while away the time.

To accommodate a lower powered battery and thus reduce overall price, the Zire does the unforgivable: it carries a display that isn't backlit—a move that vastly reduces usability of the device. Moreover, a 16-shade monochrome screen coupled with a 16 MHz processor imparts a sluggish performance—applications are slow to load and the scrolling is visibly stuttered.

The Tungsten carries PIM applications and then some. Notable additions are Documents To Go Professional (v5.0), VersaMail, Web Browser Pro and Voice Memo. These let the device read, edit and synchronise Microsoft Office files, send and receive e-mail, access the Internet and capture your thoughts as voice memos (stored as WAV files), respectively. Documents To Go deserves more than a mention—the software is very capable of maintaining the format of Office documents. In Word, for example, headings, fonts, bullets, embedded images and tables in a PC-based document are accurately converted to a format suitable to the Tungsten T. Editing is somewhat limited but the changes in formatting are successfully synched with the original document. Spreadsheets are similarly treated (although the Professional version cannot create a chart, something reserved for the Premium version), as are pre-

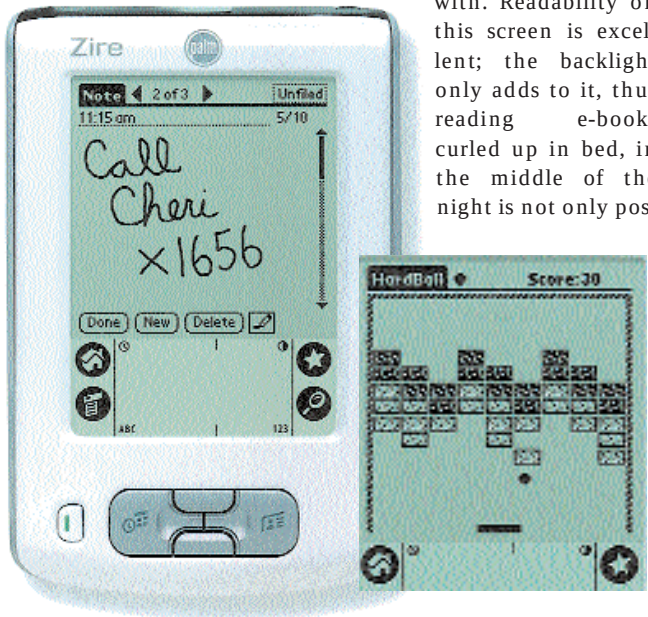
sentations. Cross-integration of software is also neatly executed. VersaMail supports HotSync mail synchronisation (between PC and handheld) as well as direct POP and IMAP connections for multiple accounts. It also supports attachment conversion: Word,

MHz dual-core processor that packs in an integrated DSP co-processor for accelerating media-rich applications, and the 65,000+ colour display. The transreflective TFT screen is a joy to behold, especially with the high-resolution fonts that OS 5.0 bundles with. Readability on this screen is excellent; the backlight only adds to it, thus reading e-books curled up in bed, in the middle of the night is not only pos-

is present, a visual cue for a full charge is notably missed in both the Palm devices. The Zire does amazingly well as far as battery life is concerned—a similar test on this device saw it chug along for 13 hours straight! Recharging the Zire is done via an AC adapter and data synching via a USB cable.

The Tungsten can communicate using the integrated Bluetooth and an IR port. Accessing the Internet on the handheld alongside a Bluetooth-compliant GSM/GPRS phone (such as the Sony Ericsson T68i) is a real treat. Data transfer between devices is also possible via the IR-port up to a range of 5 feet. An SDIO slot allows expansion of memory (up to 512 MB from the built-in 16 MB); interfacing of peripherals such as a camera and experiencing multimedia-rich video games distributed on both SD cards and MultiMediaCard media. A headphone jack for stereo audio and a Universal Connector for peripherals such as the keyboard mentioned earlier, complete the package that is the Tungsten T.

Reiterating the obvious—both, the products are meant for vastly different audiences and application areas. The Tungsten T is packed with features, is high on speed and is just what the doctor ordered for the gadget-deprived. The Zire, on the other hand, acts as the perfect supplement for those hoping to sink their teeth into a handheld that is a little more than a PIM device.



The Palm Zire

Pros: Affordable, good battery life, comprehensive PIM applications

Cons: No Palm Universal Connector, no backlight, no expansion slots

Excel, and PowerPoint files can be automatically converted during synchronisation to and from a format suited to Documents To Go.

Multimedia such as video clips, digital audio files, photos and games are extremely responsive and great to look at on the Tungsten. This is possible largely due to the 144

sible but also very easy on the eyes. The T supports polyphonic tones, MIDI and WAV playback. Its processor also supports MP3 decoding. However, a suitable player is sadly absent.

The T runs on a rechargeable Lithium Ion polymer battery that lasts for a little more than 3 hours. Recharging is done via a HotSync USB cradle and it takes 2 hours. While low power indication

Palm Tungsten T
Price: Rs 28,500
Contact: Tech Pacific Technology (India) Limited
Phone: 022-55960101

SPECIFICATIONS

159 gm, 16 MB RAM, Palm OS 5.0, 320x320, 65,536 colours reflective TFT display, Texas Instruments OMAP 1510 144 MHz processor, rechargeable Lithium Ion polymer battery, HotSync USB cradle with battery charger, Bluetooth 1.1 compli-

Palm Tungsten T		A-
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

ant, microphone, 3.5 mm stereo headphone jack and speaker, one-touch voice recording, dual expansion via SD/MultiMediaCard expansion slot, Palm Universal Connector for peripheral attachment, Infrared port

Palm Zire
Price: Rs 6,200
Contact: Tech Pacific Technology (India) Limited
Phone: 022-55960101

SPECIFICATIONS

109 gm, 2 MB RAM, Palm OS 4.1, 160x160, 16-shade monochrome display, Motorola Dragonball EZ 16 MHz processor,

Palm Zire		B-
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	

rechargeable Lithium Ion battery with charger, standard Mini USB connector with Palm HotSync Cable, Infrared port